RELEVANCE OF NAM IN CONTEMPORARY INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

The question which is raised under the given circumstances, when the rivalry between the two ideologically driven power blocs led by the United States and the erstwhile Soviet Union have ceased around 1990 followed by the dismemberment of the Soviet Union with the world becoming unipolar, is the need and relevance of non-alignment. Milos Minic, a Foreign Minister of Yugoslavia has expressed his observation for such situation as one cropping out of the end of the Cold War followed by the cessation of hostilities between the superpower blocs and being replaced, in many instances, by dialogue, negotiation and accommodation. The emergence of this kind of new situation in international relations calls for solution of international problems through negotiations and understanding on a greater plane and more successfully by revitalizing the United Nations. Under such changed circumstances the NAM cannot historically and practically play the same role.[14]

The end of the Cold War has replaced the “nuclear bomb” with “social bomb”, with poverty, underdevelopment, violence and terrorism topping the priority list and getting intertwined with the security problem of the South to which there can be no military solution. The richest—20 per cent of the world population—hold almost 83 per cent of the wealth and the poorest—20 per cent—hold only 1.4 per cent.[15] Such adverse economic global structure continues to negatively affect the developing countries, and NAM has a definite role in working towards a New World Order to help its member countries to alleviate the sufferings of its population.

India’s assertion at the Colombia Summit highlights that the culture and logic of NAM are not passé, but “The cold war had been so compulsive that many forgot the rationale of the origins of the Non-Aligned Movement and understood it as only an exercise in acrobatics between the overwhelming blocs. The permanent principles of peace, struggle against dominations, cooperation between nations, and the establishment of a world order more or less took a back seat”.[16] But the culture of peace, cooperation,